Project Report: Digital Literacy & Student Ambassador Program -

Course: CSE0001 - Digital Literacy

University: VIT Bhopal University

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GitHub Repository: https://github.com/harshvardhan1757-pixel/digital-literacy-project

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Introduction

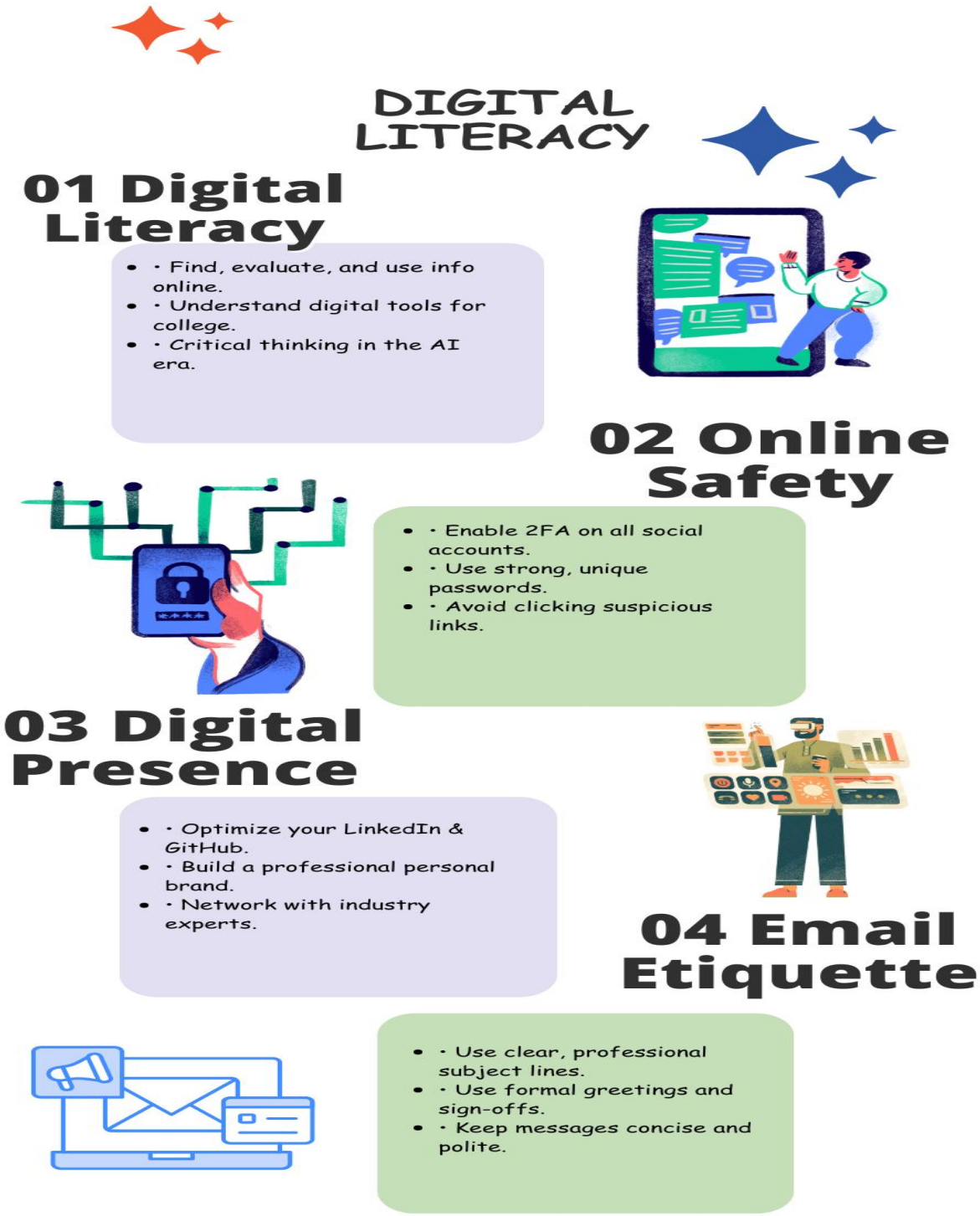
This report documents the completion of the Digital Literacy project. As a Student Digital Ambassador, the goal of this project was to establish a professional digital presence, master essential online platforms, and develop a deep understanding of cybersecurity and digital etiquette. The following sections detail the tasks performed and the reflections gained from each milestone.

Task 1: Digital Resource Creation

For this task, I designed a one-page infographic using Canva to serve as a visual resource for my peers. I chose Canva because of its versatile layout options, which allowed me to present information in a clean, scannable format.

The infographic covers four essential pillars of digital literacy: an introduction to the concept, online safety protocols (like 2FA), building a professional digital presence on platforms like LinkedIn/GitHub, and maintaining proper email etiquette. I chose these specific topics because they are the most immediate challenges first-year B.Tech students face when transitioning into a professional college environment.

One thing I found particularly interesting while creating this was the challenge of 'minimalist communication'—condensing complex security practices and professional standards into just three bullet points per section without losing the core message. Balancing the visual elements with technical information helped me better understand how to communicate effectively as a Student Digital Ambassador.

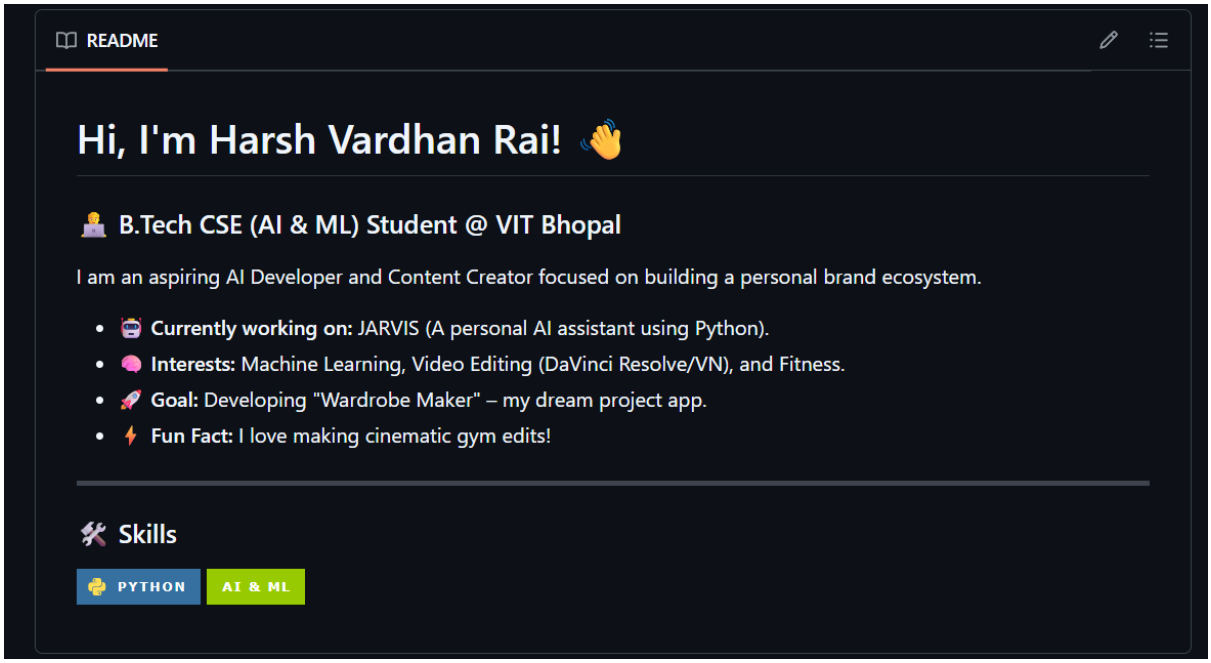


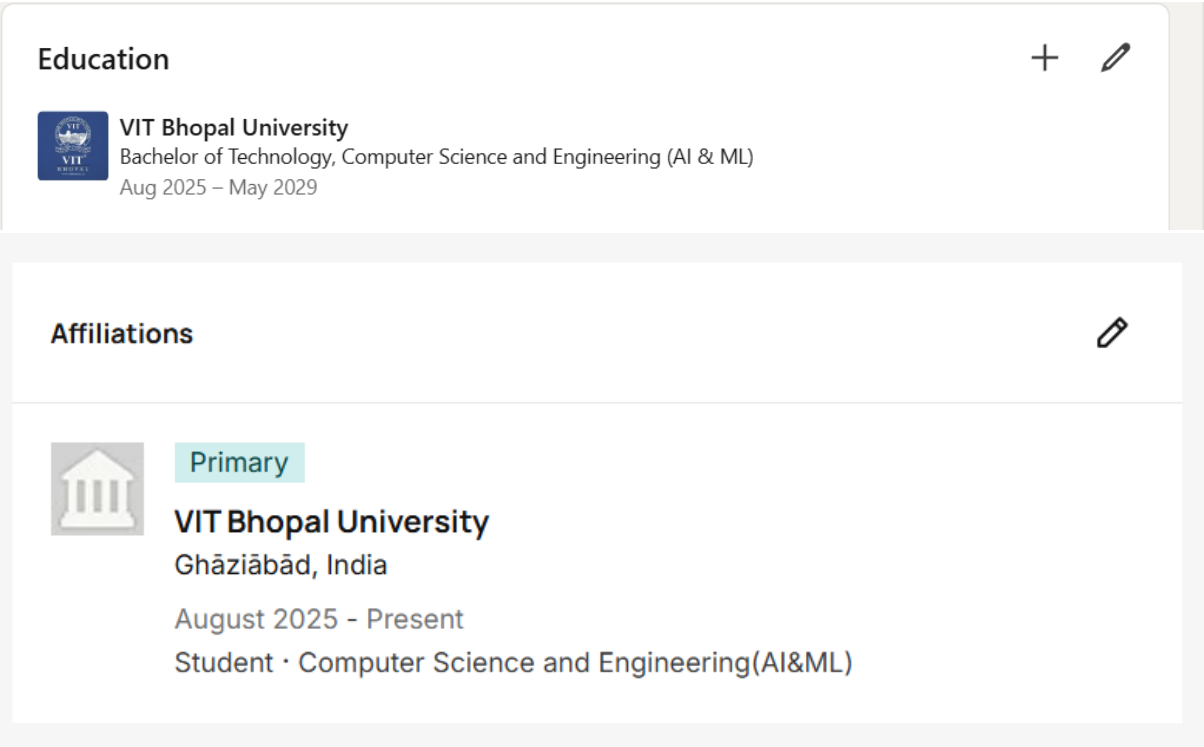
Task 2: Professional Digital Portfolio

For the Digital Portfolio task, I established and updated my professional presence on GitHub, LinkedIn, and ResearchGate. I chose these platforms because they align perfectly with my specialization in AI & ML and my long-term goal of building a personal brand.

On GitHub, I created a specialized 'Profile README' repository to introduce myself to the developer community and showcase my ongoing projects, specifically my Python-based AI assistant, JARVIS. On LinkedIn, I updated my academic credentials at VIT Bhopal to connect with industry professionals and peers. Finally, I set up a ResearchGate/Kaggle profile to engage with academic and data science communities.

Over the next four years, I plan to use GitHub as a public ledger for my code, LinkedIn to network for my upcoming 'Wardrobe Maker' app project, and specialized platforms to sharpen my machine learning skills. Building these profiles early ensures that my digital footprint is professional and ready for future internship opportunities.





Task 3: Platforms & Technical Assessment

In Task 3, I focused on navigating technical assessment and data collection platforms. I utilized HackerRank to solve a Python-based coding challenge, which allowed me to practice using an Integrated Development Environment (IDE) and understand how automated test cases validate code. This is particularly relevant to my specialization in AI & ML, where platform-based evaluations are a standard.

Furthermore, I demonstrated digital administrative skills by creating a "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" via Google Forms. Navigating these platforms helped me understand the importance of 'Platform Literacy'—the ability to quickly adapt to different user interfaces and data entry requirements. This task reinforced that being digitally literate is not just about using social media, but about efficiently utilizing professional tools for evaluation and feedback.

Upload Code as File

Test against custom input

Run Code

Submit Code

You have earned 5.00 points!

You are now 30 points away from the 1st star for your python badge.

14%

5/35

Congratulations

You solved this challenge. Would you like to challenge your friends?

Next Challenge

Test case 0

Compiler Message

Success

Preview mode

Published

Copy responder link

Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz – 2026

A quick assessment to help our batch navigate the digital world safely and professionally.

* Indicates required question

*

Full Name & Registration Number

Your answer

Which of the following is the most secure way to protect your accounts?

- Using the same password for all sites
- Enabling Two-Factor Authentication (2FA)
- Sharing your PIN with close friends
- Saving passwords in a public notepad

Untitled form (Responses)

File Edit View Insert Format Data Tools Gemini Extensions Help

Share

A1 Timestamp

Form_Responses

Timestamp	Full Name & Registration Number	Which of the following is the most secure wa	What does 'Digital Footprint' mean to you in a	You receive an email from "VIT-Support" askir	Which platform is best for sho

Form responses 1

Task 4: Digital Communication & Etiquette

One significant problem in digital communication is Phishing, often caused by a lack of professional etiquette awareness. A common real-world scenario involves students receiving a fake email from 'University Support' claiming their account will be deactivated unless they click a link to verify their password.

The 'poor communication' here is two-fold: the attacker uses an unprofessional, urgent tone, and the student fails to verify the sender's official domain. This lack of digital literacy led to the compromise of academic credentials and personal data. To prevent this, the communication should have been handled differently: the institution should always use official, signed emails, and the student should have practiced 'Email Etiquette' by inspecting the sender's address and hovering over links before clicking. This situation highlights that professional etiquette is not just about politeness; it is a critical layer of cybersecurity.

Social Media Etiquette for College Students -

The Do's	The Don'ts
Enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA): Always secure your accounts to protect your digital identity from unauthorized access.	Don't Share Sensitive Data: Never post your VIT Bhopal University Click to open side panel for more information registration number, OTPs, or home address.
Think Before You Post: Remember that your digital footprint is permanent; ensure your content aligns with your professional goals in AI & ML.	Avoid Cyberbullying: Do not engage in online arguments, use offensive language, or post content that could harass others.
Privacy Audits: Regularly review your privacy settings to control who can see your personal information and tagged posts.	No Plagiarism: Never post code or creative content belonging to others without providing proper credit or citations.
Verify Information: Fact-check news or technical data before sharing it to prevent the spread of misinformation within the student community.	Don't Click Suspicious Links: Avoid "Cashback" or "Account Verification" links sent via DM, as these are common phishing attempts.
Network Professionally: Use platforms like LinkedIn to showcase your projects, such as your JARVIS AI assistant, and connect with industry experts.	Avoid Over-sharing: Do not post your real-time location or detailed daily schedules that could compromise your physical safety.

Task 5: Cybercrime Case Study & Prevention

Case Study: UPI QR Code Fraud

A common cybercrime currently targeting college students in India is UPI QR Code Fraud. In this scenario, a student receives a message claiming they have won a prize or a 'cashback' reward. The attacker sends a QR code via WhatsApp and instructs the student to scan it to 'receive' the money.

The technical problem lies in the student's misunderstanding of UPI protocols: a PIN or QR scan is only required to send money, never to receive it. Once the student scans the code and enters their UPI PIN, the attacker instantly debits funds from their bank account. The consequences are not just financial loss, but also the compromise of linked mobile banking credentials.

Personal Reflection & Habit Change

What surprised me most during my research into UPI fraud was the psychological sophistication of the attackers. I realized that cybercrime isn't always about complex coding; it's often about social engineering and exploiting a user's momentary lack of attention.

As a result of this project, one habit I will personally change is my approach to incoming 'Collect Requests' on payment apps. I have now committed to the habit of pausing and verifying the sender's VPA every single time. Additionally, I have enabled biometric locks for my UPI apps to ensure that even if my phone is unlocked, my financial data remains inaccessible.

Stay Safe Online Prevention Checklist -

1. **The Golden Rule of UPI:** Never enter your UPI PIN to receive money. A PIN is only required for sending or authorizing a debit, never for a credit.
2. **Verify the Source:** Before scanning any QR code or clicking a payment link, verify the sender's VPA (Virtual Payment Address) to ensure it is a legitimate merchant.
3. **Enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA):** Activate 2FA on all academic (VIT email), social, and financial accounts to provide an extra layer of security beyond passwords.
4. **Official Reporting Channels:** Immediately report any cyber fraud on the **National Cyber Crime Portal (cybercrime.gov.in)** or call the **Helpline 1930**.
5. **Secure Your Devices:** Use biometric locks or strong passphrases for your banking apps and avoid using public Wi-Fi for any financial transactions.
6. **Fact-Check Information:** Never act on "urgent" messages claiming your bank account or SIM card will be blocked. Contact your bank directly through official channels.
7. **Audit App Permissions:** Regularly check which apps have access to your SMS and Contacts to prevent data harvesting or "SMS Forwarding" scams.
8. **Stay Updated:** Keep your phone's operating system and all financial apps updated to ensure you have the latest security patches against vulnerabilities.

Conclusion

Completing this project has significantly enhanced my digital literacy. From technical platform management to understanding the nuances of professional communication, I am now better equipped to navigate the digital landscape of an AI & ML professional.

References

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